Kien Le

kienle1404 | kienle414 | lekien140405@gmail.com

Summary

Graduate researcher at Florida State University with interests in AI security and systems. My work addresses different dimensions of AI reliability: adversarial robustness in LLMs and GNNs, privacy-preserving federated learning for healthcare applications, and systems-level compiler optimizations. These experiences have shaped my understanding of how to build AI systems that are secure, private, and efficient. I am interested in exploring how security and privacy considerations intersect with practical system design, with a focus on integrity and trustworthiness in AI systems.

Education

2026 – 2028 **Florida State University**, M.S. in Computer Science

2023 – 2026 **Florida State University (Honors)**, B.S. in Computer Science (GPA: 3.875/4.0)
Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, OOP, Discrete Math, Probability, OS, Data Mining.
Honors: President's List (S24, S25), Dean's List (F23, F24, F25)

Research Experience

Research Assistant, ML for Smart Healthcare (w/ Dr. Tuy Nguyen) Jan 2026 – Present

- Developing dual-attention transformer mechanism for personalized federated learning in ECG classification, improving classification performance while preserving patient privacy in federated learning settings.
- Implementing and evaluating personalized FL approaches using PyTorch framework, analyzing trade-offs between model personalization and communication efficiency.
- Co-authoring paper for MWSCAS 2026 on transformer-based personalized federated learning for medical time-series classification.

Research Assistant, Compiler Optimization (w/ Dr. David Whalley) Jul 2025 – Jan 2026

- Working on backend optimizations in the Very Portable Optimizer (VPO), including copy propagation, branch chaining, and tail duplication.
- Investigating low-level backend optimizations in a compiler, analyzing how transformations impact performance, correctness, and system behavior across benchmarks.
- Collaborating on debugging optimization sequences, identifying failure points, and refining transformation ordering to ensure stable compiler behavior.

Researcher, Large Language Model Security (w/ Dr. Yushun Dong) Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

- Co-developing a query-efficient attack framework for extracting domain knowledge from black-box LLMs, focusing on efficiency, robustness, and real-world feasibility.
- Designing adaptive query strategies that balance fidelity and efficiency through self-directed exploration and uncertainty feedback.
- Co-author of "Query-Efficient Domain Knowledge Stealing Against Large Language Models," accepted to AAAI 2026.

Researcher, GNN Security (w/ Dr. Yushun Dong) Aug 2024 – Apr 2025

- Leveraging PyTorch Geometric baselines (GraphSAGE, GIN) to evaluate query-based model extraction and ownership verification attacks on GNNs.
- Studying robustness and ownership verification in graph-based learning systems under adversarial settings.
- Contributed an open-source implementation of **GNNFingers** to the **PyGIP library**, improving

reproducibility and accessibility for GNN security research.

Publications

Zhengao Li, Xiaopeng Yuan, Bolin Shen, **Kien Le**, Haohan Wang, Xugui Zhou, Shangqian Gao, Yushun Dong. "**Query-Efficient Domain Knowledge Stealing Against Large Language Models**." *AAAI 2026 Conference on Artificial Intelligence*.

Professional Experience

Academic Tutor, **Academic Center for Excellence** Aug 2024 – Present

- Provide one-on-one and small-group tutoring in computer science and mathematics.
- Guide students through problem-solving strategies, algorithmic thinking, and debugging techniques

Web Development Intern, **FPT Software** May 2024 – Aug 2024

- Developed full-stack CRUD applications using Java Spring Boot, MySQL, and REST APIs.
- Integrated AWS deployment pipelines and JPA for data persistence.

Content Migration Intern, **BeOnline Co., Ltd** Jun 2021 – Aug 2021

- Migrated 600+ English-learning resources to the TiengAnh123 mobile app (100k+ downloads) using HTML/CSS.
- Ensured consistent design and accessibility across platforms.

Projects

GNNFingers Implementation

- Implementation and extension of *GNNFingers: A Fingerprinting Framework for Verifying Ownerships of Graph Neural Networks*.
- Built on PyTorch Geometric; added fingerprint embedding and ownership verification modules.
- Contributed implementation and docs to the open-source **PyGIP** library to improve reproducibility.

Cat vs Dog Image Classifier (CNN) GitHub

- Implemented a PyTorch CNN for binary image classification.
- Achieved 84% test accuracy via augmentation, normalization, and regularization.

Skills

Programming Languages	Python, C/C++, Java, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS
Frameworks & Libraries	PyTorch, DGL, TensorFlow, Spring Boot, React, Node.js, Express
Research Tools	PyTorch Geometric, scikit-learn, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, GNU Debugger
DevOps & Platforms	Git/GitHub, Postman, Linux Shell
Languages	English (Proficient), Vietnamese (Native)

Honors & Leadership

2025	2nd Place — ShellHacks Waymo Project
2024	1st Place — FSU ACM Programming Contest (Upper Division)
Sep – Dec 2024	Honors Colloquium Leader, FSU Honors Program